

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION

SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER

Academic Session: 2026–27

Class: 9

Subject: English

Maximum Marks: 30

Time Allowed: 1 hour 30 minutes

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

- **The question paper is divided into four sections: Reading, Writing & Grammar, and Literature.**

- All questions are compulsory.
- Read the instructions carefully for each section and question.
- Adhere to the prescribed word limit wherever specified.

SECTION A

Reading

Q1. Read the following excerpt and answer the questions that follow:

The old woman sat by the window, her hands gnarled with age, tracing patterns on the condensation. Outside, the city hummed a familiar, yet distant, tune. She remembered a time

when the hum was different, filled with the laughter of children playing hopscotch on cobbled streets, not the monotonous drone of traffic. Her eyes, though clouded, still held a spark of defiance, a quiet refusal to let the present erase the vivid tapestry of her past. A half-finished embroidery lay in her lap, a testament to fading eyesight and unwavering spirit.

(A) What does the "monotonous drone of traffic" suggest about the current city environment?

(B) What does the phrase "spark of defiance" imply about the old woman's character?

(C) The embroidery in her lap symbolizes:

(i) Her love for art.

(ii) Her inability to complete tasks.

(iii) Her resilience despite physical limitations.

(iv) Her desire for companionship.

(D) Find a word from the passage that means "twisted or knotty."

(1 Mark)

Q2. Based on the passage, which of the following statements is true?

(A) The old woman prefers the present city to the past.

(B) Her eyesight has improved with age.

(C) She actively resists forgetting her past.

(D) The city's sounds are a source of joy for her.

(1 Mark)

SECTION B

Writing & Grammar

Q3. Complete the following paragraph by choosing the most appropriate options:

The young artist, (i) _____ talent was undeniable, struggled (ii) _____ recognition. He painted with a passion that few understood, often working through the night. His canvases, vibrant with colour and emotion, (iii) _____ often dismissed as too unconventional.

(i)

(A) whose

(B) who's

(C) which

(D) whom

(ii)

(A) for

(B) with

(C) from

(D) by

(iii)

(A) is

(B) were

(C) has been

(D) had been

(3 Marks)

Q4. Rearrange the following words and phrases to form meaningful sentences:

(A) the / of / importance / education / cannot / overstated / be

(B) a / for / future / sustainable / crucial / is / renewable / energy

(2 Marks)

Q5. You are Riya/Rohan, a student of Class 9. Write a short paragraph (approximately 80-100 words) for your school magazine about the importance of reading books in the digital age. Emphasize how books offer a unique escape and foster critical thinking.

(4 Marks)

SECTION C

Literature

Q6. Read the following extract and answer the questions that follow:

"Two roads diverged in a yellow wood,
And sorry I could not travel both
And be one traveler, long I stood
And looked down one as far as I could
To where it bent in the undergrowth;"

(A) What does "yellow wood" symbolize in the poem?

(B) What is the central dilemma faced by the speaker?

(C) The phrase "long I stood" suggests:

- (i) The speaker's indecision.
- (ii) The speaker's physical exhaustion.
- (iii) The speaker's enjoyment of the scenery.
- (iv) The speaker's wait for a companion.

(D) Identify the poetic device used in the line "Two roads diverged in a yellow wood."

(1 Mark)

Q7. How does the character of Toto in "The Adventures of Toto" highlight the mischievous and unpredictable nature of animals? Provide specific examples from the story.

(3 Marks)

Q8. In the poem "The Road Not Taken," what is the significance of the speaker choosing the "less traveled" road? What does this choice reveal about human nature?

(3 Marks)

SECTION D

Long Answer Questions

Q9. Imagine you are the young boy from "The Lost Child." Years later, you revisit the fair. Describe your feelings and observations, reflecting on how your perspective has changed and what memories resurface. (Word limit: 120-150 words)

(5 Marks)

SECTION E

Case Study

Q10. Read the following scenario and answer the questions based on your understanding of the chapter "A Truly Beautiful Mind":

Albert, a brilliant but unconventional student, struggles to conform to the rigid academic structure of his school. His teachers often find him disruptive and his ideas too abstract. He

prefers to learn through experimentation and independent thought rather than rote memorization. This often leads to clashes with authority figures who value discipline and traditional methods.

(A) How does Albert's struggle in the scenario reflect the challenges faced by Albert Einstein in his early life?

(B) What qualities of Albert (in the scenario) are indicative of a "truly beautiful mind" as depicted in the chapter?

(C) If you were Albert's teacher, what approach would you take to nurture his talent while also ensuring he adheres to some academic discipline?

(D) What is the primary difference between Albert's learning style and the traditional academic approach described?

(4 Marks)

End of Question Paper